Nicolas Berlinski

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Public Finance, Urban Economics

WORKING PAPERS

- **Property Tax Self-Sufficiency and New Housing: Evidence from New York City** (Third Year Paper; draft available upon request)
  - Evaluates the property tax self-sufficiency of new housing in New York City using a sufficient-statistics framework based on the congestion-fee view of property taxes. Using parcel-level data on redevelopment and property tax histories, I estimate that appraised market values and property tax liabilities rise to approximately 4.6 and 4.2 times their pre-redevelopment levels, an annual revenue gain of $1.1–1.3 billion net of exemptions ($4.0–4.3 billion without exemptions). Direct revenue gains cover incremental service costs if marginal costs are at most 25% of current spending per household.

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Red Tape or Green Preservation? Environmental Review and Housing Development**
  - Studies the tradeoff between externality mitigation and housing supply under Washington State's environmental review law (SEPA), combining granular permit data across jurisdictions in the Seattle metropolitan area with a novel LLM-assisted dataset of the anticipated externalities disclosed in SEPA review and the review outcomes that follow.
- **Algorithmic Tax Audit Selection: Evidence from the Dominican Republic** (with Thiago Scot and Jose Carlos Bermúdez)
  - Studies the rollout of a deterministic risk-based audit-ranking algorithm in the Dominican Republic, which mandated that auditors select a fixed share of quarterly audits from the algorithm's high-priority candidates. Using audit-, auditor-, and taxpayer-level data, we study how the algorithm changes bureaucrats' audit selection behavior.

PRE-DOCTORAL PUBLICATIONS

- Berlinski N, Doyle M, Guess AM, et al. The Effects of Unsubstantiated Claims of Voter Fraud on Confidence in Elections. Journal of Experimental Political Science. 2023;10(1):34-49. doi:10.1017/XPS.2021.18
- Chockalingam, V., Wu, V., Berlinski, N., Chandra, Z., Hu, A., Jones, E., Kramer, J., Li, X. S., Monfre, T., Ng, Y. S., Sach, M., Smith-Lopez, M., Solomon, S., Sosanya, A., & Nyhan, B. (2021). The limited effects of partisan and consensus messaging in correcting science misperceptions. Research & Politics, 8(2). https://doi.org/10.1177/20531680211014980

EDUCATION

University of Maryland, College Park, MD, USA — Expected May 2029
Ph.D. in Economics

University of Maryland, College Park, MD, USA — May 2025
M.A. in Economics

Dartmouth College, Hanover, NH, USA — June 2021
B.A. in Economics and Government (High Honors with Distinction), Magna Cum Laude
Thesis Title: The Message or the Messenger? A Comparative Study of the Mechanisms of News Media Effects

ACADEMIC/PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of Maryland — College Park, MD, USA
Teaching Assistant — August 2023 — Present

- Supports teaching activities in the Applied Economics M.S. program.
- Holds office hours, grades assignments, conducts review session for students in core microeconomics courses.

- Provides career advising for undergraduate students.

World Bank Washington, DC, USA
Short-Term Consultant January 2025 — Present

- Supporting research efforts within the Development Impact Group (DIME)
- Evaluating the implementation of electronic invoicing technologies in LMICs
- Collaborating with public-sector officials in the Caribbean to conduct program evaluations

Cornerstone Research New York City, NY, USA
Analyst August 2021 — July 2023

- Applied quantitative and qualitative research skills to support economics and finance experts in commercial litigation matters.
- Conducted econometric analysis of large databases using SQL, R, Stata, and Netezza in US, EU, and Australian antitrust investigations.
- Conducted qualitative research of court documents and academic literature to support litigation efforts of clients.
- Collaborated on large case teams in a dynamic fast-paced work environment.

Dartmouth College Department of Economics Hanover, NH, USA
Research Assistant to Professor Eric Chyn September 2020 — May 2021

- Constructed a unique Texas criminal records database using Stata to study attorney performance for indigent defendants.
- Conducted econometric analysis of the relationship between attorney quality and defendant outcomes.

Analysis Group Boston, MA, USA
Summer Analyst July 2020 — August 2020

- Collaborated on mock casework regarding a federal lawsuit against a pharmaceutical company for improper honoraria payments to physicians.
- Constructed a unique dataset of drug prescriptions and honoraria payments for damage calculations in R.
- Conducted econometric analysis to understand the prescription behavior of physicians who received honoraria payments.

Dartmouth College Department of Government Hanover, NH, USA
Research Assistant to Professors Brendan Nyhan and John Carey September 2018 — June 2020

- Co-authored an empirical paper, published in the Journal of Experimental Political Science, on the effect that false claims of voter fraud have on public confidence in democracy.
- Collaborated on statistical analysis of survey data on American democratic health and performance for publication.
- Completed a historical and comparative study of malapportionment in the U.S. Senate.

Center for Strategic and International Studies Washington, DC, USA
Research Intern, Project for Prosperity and Development January 2019 — March 2019

- Supported department research efforts on topics such as development project financing, the Afghan conflict, the international migrant crisis, infrastructure development in Argentina, and the UN Sustainable Development Goals.

TEACHING

Instructor, University of Maryland

- ECON 454: Public Finance and Public Policy (Undergraduate) Summer 2026

Teaching Assistant, University of Maryland

- ECON 326: Intermediate Microeconomics (Undergraduate) Fall 2026
- ECON 673: Information, Game Theory, and Market Design (M.S. in Applied Economics) Spring 2025, Spring 2026
- ECON 670: Financial Economics (M.S. in Applied Economics) Spring 2025
- ECON 643: Empirical Analysis I: Foundations of Empirical Research (M.S. in Applied Economics) Spring 2025

AWARDS

Melville J. Ulmer Graduate Fellowship in Economics — Second Prize College Park, MD, USA
2026

- Awarded by the University of Maryland Department of Economics for the best second year paper

Rockefeller Prize for Outstanding Thesis in Comparative Politics Hanover, NH, USA
June 2021

- Awarded by the Dartmouth College Government Department to the best senior honors thesis in the field of Comparative Politics

GRANTS

Dartmouth Undergraduate Advising and Research Senior Thesis Grant Hanover, NH, USA
October 2020

- $2,500 research grant to conduct a survey-based experiment on the impact of news media slant and news source on persuasion

The Nelson A. Rockefeller Center Senior Thesis Grant Hanover, NH, USA
October 2020

- $1,000 research grant to conduct a survey-based experiment on the impact of news media slant and news source on persuasion

Dartmouth College Department of Government Senior Thesis Grant Hanover, NH, USA
October 2020

- $500 research grant to conduct a survey-based experiment on the impact of news media slant and news source on persuasion

SKILLS

- **Programming:** Highly Proficient in R and Stata. Proficiency in Matlab, Python, and LaTeX. Experience using survey programming software such as Qualtrics.
- **AI Tools:** Claude Code, OpenAI Codex
- **Software:** Highly Proficient in Microsoft Office
- **Languages:** English (native), Spanish (native), French (basic)